

THE DM REFERENCE GUIDE

The King's Crusade

OVERVIEW

This document is the table's working reference, not a fifth telling of the setting or the story. It gathers three things a DM needs at hand and does not want to hunt for across seventeen other files: a one-page map of the whole campaign's shape, an index of every stat block already built so a name can be found without a search, a table of where every puzzle in the campaign is and what solves it, and the Branch Ledger — the compiled record of every tracked divergence, module by module, with a blank column for what actually happened at this table. Everything here is drawn from the sourcebook, the gazetteer, the bestiary and the eleven module slots; nothing here is new canon, and none of the campaign's deliberately open questions have been quietly settled to make this document tidier.

Use it during play as a quick-lookup: which module a name belongs to, what CR a recurring stat block sits at, what got decided last session that this session might reference. Use the Branch Ledger after every session, not just at the end of the campaign — an entry filled in while it is fresh is worth more than one reconstructed from memory two modules later.

CAMPAIGN AT A GLANCE

Eleven module slots (twelve files — Module Two forks by road and only one half is played). Starting level 5, milestone advancement, built for a party of 4–6. Each module's own Overview carries a scene-by-scene pacing table against its five-hour budget; this table is the one-line shape of the whole march.

Module	Title	Core Content
1	The Muster	Duncarrow; the wyvern at Greywatch; the road choice — sea or mountain.
2A	The Sea Road	Warden Thane's hold; the port of Calanthe and its fate.
2B	The Mountain Road	The Ashgate Ford; Baron Vell's toll-keep.
3	Landfall	First ground in occupied Elduvaine; the checkpoint; Wyn Alder.
4	The Coalition	Sennoch Hall rescue; the Ward freed; Doria Kell and Norvatch.
5	The Road to Vindana	The second king's drowning resolved; mourning at the Standing Water.
6	The Siege of Vindana: Investment	Engines raised; the supply raid; First Assault.
7	The Siege of Vindana: The Breaking	Marshal Drell's fate; the city breaks; Xavier becomes the Wyvernheart.
8	Held Ground	Securing Vindana; the Magistrate freed.
9	The Field Battle	General Voss's army met in the open and broken; Tam Ondry.
10	The Approach	The march on Caer Ysolde; the Regent; Norvatch names its price.
11	The Decision at the Gates (Final)	Caer Ysolde falls; Maedoc Vale confronted; hold or set down.

PEOPLES AT A GLANCE

Every realm is mixed; the table is who a party actually meets there and in what proportion. The load-bearing rule is that nobody in this campaign is their species — dwarves hunt wyverns in Harrowmark and keep contracts in Norvatch, and orcs fight on both sides of this war without a single NPC remarking on it.

Realm or faction	Who you meet	What the place makes of them
Harrowmark	Humans, dwarves, orcs; half-orcs and half-elves throughout	Wyvern country. Dwarves on the pikes, orcs on the ropes, nine centuries unchanged. All magic is worked, professional and carried in a person, because the land does nothing.
Elduvaine	Elves, gnomes, halflings, humans — plus dryads, sprites and satyrs	Elves keep the Kept Season orchards; gnomes clerk the Archive and cut the light-stone; halflings hold the river parishes and supply the whole kingdom's manners.
Oksitan	Humans, dragonborn nobility, half-elves at court	River and horse country. Dragonborn houses have held the same fords for longer than the records go back.

Realm or faction	Who you meet	What the place makes of them
Auberitz	Humans, gnomes, halflings	The duchy that builds things. The coalition's siege train is theirs, gnome-designed and halfling-quartermastered.
Norvatch	Dwarves, tieflings, humans	Guild-law country. A bargain is written, witnessed and binding, and honoured to the letter no matter what the letter turns out to have meant.
The occupation	Hobgoblin core; orc, human, goblin auxiliaries; Elduvish clerks	A hired legion, not a horde. Permits, a published grain levy, competent officers, no fanatics. They are employees.

STAT BLOCK INDEX

Every named stat block built so far, in order of first appearance. "SRD base" names the unmodified SRD creature a block was built from — renamed blocks keep the base creature's numbers exactly and change only name, flavor text, and (where noted in the module) minor cosmetic description. The Occupation Guard is defined in Module 3, reprinted in full in Module 4 because that module's own fight needs it to hand, and pointed at by reference in Modules 6, 7, 9 and 11.

Name	SRD Base	CR (XP)	AC	HP	Module
Wyvern	Wyvern, unmodified	6 (2,300)	13	110	1 — The Muster
Warden Ivor Thane	Veteran, renamed	3 (700)	17	58	2A — The Sea Road
Thane's Guard	Bandit, unmodified	1/8 (25)	12	11	2A — The Sea Road
Baron Osgar Vell	Bandit Captain, renamed	2 (450)	15	65	2B — The Mountain Road
Ashgate Scout	Scout, unmodified	1/2 (100)	13	16	2B — The Mountain Road
Occupation Guard	Guard, unmodified	1/8 (25)	16	11	3 — Landfall (reused: 4, 6, 7, 9, 11)
Marshal Ossian Drell	Veteran, renamed	3 (700)	17	58	6 — Vindana: Investment (returns: 7)
General Ilyana Voss	Gladiator, renamed	5 (1,800)	16	112	9 — The Field Battle
Maedoc Vale	Archmage, renamed	12 (8,400)	15	99	11 — The Decision at the Gates

A stat block's full traits and actions live only in its own module's script — this index is for finding the right file fast, not for running the creature from this page alone.

CREATURES CALLED FOR BY REFERENCE

These are used by name in the modules without a reprinted block, because they are unmodified SRD entries a DM can look up in seconds. All are 2014 SRD.

Creature	CR (XP)	Where it is called for
Kobold	1/8 (25)	The old workings above Ashgate (2B, optional); Vindana's undercity (6). Trap-layers and negotiators, not a slaughter.
Winter Wolf	3 (700)	The Held Winter (5, optional). Hunts the wood's edges.
Troll	5 (1,800)	The Held Winter (5, optional). Has taken the orchard-keeper's cottage. Regeneration is the fight.
Dryad	1 (200)	The Held Winter (5, optional). Not an encounter — a conversation, and the campaign's grief in one NPC.
Sprite	1/4 (50)	Caerwyn's orchard hedge (3). Four inches of extremely rude opinion. Pure texture.
Ogre	2 (450)	The mountain road (2B, optional), as an alternative to the kobold workings.

THE ELDUVISH WONDERS

Four habits made portable, and the campaign's best treasure. Ordinary inside Elduvaine, astonishing everywhere else.

Wonder	What it does	First available
Standing-stone lamp	Gnome-cut stone that holds daylight poured into it and gives it back for hours.	Module 3, from Caerwyn's baker
Flask of Listening Water	Holds what is said at its mouth; gives it back once, in the speaker's own voice.	Module 5, at the Standing Water
Road-token	Cut from a Willing Road waystone. Explains itself no more than the road does.	DM's discretion
Kept Season seeds	A small stand holds whatever season the seeds were sown in.	DM's discretion

KEPT OUT OF THE PLAYER-FACING BOOK

Three pieces of DM material used to sit in Character Options, which is a book a player is handed. They live here now. The first two are guidance; the third is an item no player character can ever attune, whose description gives away one of the campaign's two clocks.

THE SLEEPING ARCHIVE

DM Only: the warlock patron does not answer what is in the deepest vaults, and a DM should be careful not to let a player conclude that it does. The dragon sleeps under the building. It is not a key to the building's contents, it does not know what is on the sealed shelves, and its interest in the campaign is entirely its own. If a player asks, the honest answer is that it has never said. The patron's entry in Character Options says only that something older than the wards sleeps near or under the Archive, which is all a warlock's player needs and all they should get.

DRAW DOWN

DM Only: a player character can learn the occupation's draining spell. Nothing in the rules prevents it and nothing in the books will stop them. What should happen is that an Elduvish NPC sees them cast it, and the campaign should absolutely make that a scene. Character Options says as much to the player, in the player's own terms, and stops there.

KEPT SEASON SEEDS

DM Only: give the seeds to the party early and then never mention them again. The item's whole value is that it is not an adventuring item: it is a thing they can plant somewhere they choose and come back to in an epilogue, and it only lands if nobody has been nudging them toward it for nine modules. Character Options tells the player what it does and says nothing about when they will get it.

SOVEREIGN'S VEIL

Wondrous item, very rare (requires attunement by the reigning sovereign of Elduvaine)

Grey silk, unremarkable, and the reason nobody has seen Maelis Ysolde's face in four years. While attuned and worn, the wearer cannot be scried, read, charmed or compelled, cannot be lied to about the state of Elduvaine's habits, and knows at all times, precisely, how much of the Living Realm remains.

The last of those is not a benefit and was never intended as one. It was made so that a sovereign would always know the condition of the thing they were bound to, in a kingdom where that binding was a nine-hundred-year source of long life and good weather. She has worn it through three years of the draining.

DM Only: the veil is here so that a DM knows it exists and knows exactly what it has been doing to her, and not because it is loot. It cannot be taken, attunes to nobody else, and does nothing for anyone not bound to the habits. If a party asks her what the number is, she will tell them, and it is the single most demoralising piece of information available anywhere in the campaign, and she will give it without softening it because she has never once softened anything. It was in the player-facing options book by mistake: the attunement line alone tells a player that Elduvaine's sovereign is bound to the land, which is a Module Eleven reveal.

RECURRING NPCs

Named NPCs the campaign's own modules flag as "open threads" — built to be brought back, not to be used once and discarded. The royal house is named in the sourcebook: Maelis, Aveline, Ninian, Ottoline and Emrys. The titles below are how the modules refer to them at the table, because that is how the party meets them.

Name	Introduced	Role
Xavier III of Harrowmark	1	The calling king. Leads in person; not yet the Wyvernheart until Module 7.
Huntmaster Brenna Vane (dwarf)	1	Greywatch's huntmaster, two centuries old; runs the wyvern hunt; a recurring source of camp levity.

Name	Introduced	Role
Sera Vosk (rock gnome)	2A	Auberitz quartermaster; a standing logistics and information contact.
Garrick Hollow (half-elf)	2B	Hired mountain guide; a standing source for overland routes and rumor.
Wyn Alder (gnome)	3	An occupation-era clerk at the Landfall checkpoint; the campaign's first answer to what an ordinary complicit person looks like.
Doria Kell (tiefling)	4	Norvatch factor, and the campaign's second-largest lever. Her house has been buying Elduvaine by weight for three years; her ledgers are the clock. Names her price in Module 10.
The Ward (half-elf)	4	Royal house, freed at Sennoch Hall. Precise rather than broken; a standing voice for what the liberated want.
Tam Ondry	5	Harrowmark courier attached to the lost column; a standing source for news arriving from elsewhere.
Marshal Ossian Drell (hobgoblin)	6	Commands Vindana's garrison; a legionary professional on a contract, not a fanatic. Fate resolved in Module 7.
The Magistrate (gnome)	8	Royal house, freed in Vindana; the Ward's great-aunt by marriage. Fought her captivity with bureaucratic warfare and won.
General Ilyana Voss (orc)	9	Commands Vale's field army; came up through the same legion as Drell. Fate resolved this module; a captured Voss is a real long-term asset.
Aveline Ysolde, the Regent (human)	10	Royal house, at large; runs what resistance survives and refuses evacuation. Has refused it in writing, twice. Stat block in the bestiary.
Maelis Ysolde, the Veiled Sovereign (elf)	11	Held in Caer Ysolde. Dying at the same rate as the land, because a sovereign is bound to the habits. The campaign's second clock, and the one that cannot be bought. No stat block, deliberately.
Ninian Ysolde, the Ward (half-elf)	4	Freed at Sennoch Hall. Heir presumptive, and the one who has done the arithmetic on the Promise.
Ottoline Vahn, the Magistrate (gnome)	8	Freed in Vindana. Fought three years of captivity by filing, and won. Holds the only complete record of the occupation.
Emrys Ysolde, the Envoy (elf)	—	Held separately, and not entirely as a prisoner. Has been talking to Vale for three years. Complexity in the cost, not the cause; there is no reveal and no resolution.
Raimon V of Oksitan (human)	5	The second crown, seventy-one and undeterred. Takes the road the party does not and drowns fording the Vaskren. Reaches the party as rumour, then refugees, then a problem.
Serjeant Hoth (hobgoblin)	4	Held Sennoch Hall correctly for three years and would like that written down. Surrenders on terms, with the file.
Maedoc Vale	11	The wizard. Appears in person only here. Whether he is still human is deliberately unresolved.

FAITH AND FACTIONS AT A GLANCE

The Concord holds that the Works made the world and withdrew while it was unfinished. Nine of them, worshipped across Harrowmark, Oksitan, Auberitz and Norvatch. Elduvaine never built a church at all, because you do not raise a temple to ask for an answer in a country where the river answers directly.

The Work	Sphere	Domains
Ashet the Anvil	Craft, making, the honest tool	Knowledge, War
Voran of the Long Road	Travel, messengers, guest-right	Life, Trickery
Sennet the Witness	Oath, contract, law, testimony	Knowledge, Trickery
Halevin the Hearth-Kept	Home, harvest, healing	Life, Nature
Aurine the Unshuttered	Light, truth, dawn, courage	Light
Duran Ninefold	War as discipline; the held line	War
Threnn Greywater	Sea, storm, river, the drowned	Tempest
Ossuar the Quiet Warden	Death, the grave, remembrance	Death

The Work	Sphere	Domains
Saveth of the Green Verge	Wilds, beasts, the seasons	Nature
Faction	Standing, in three steps	What the top step gets you
The Crusade	Sworn · Lance · Banner of the Call	Xavier without an appointment, and the standing to ask the coalition for something it does not want to give.
The Order of the Tenth Work	Postulant · Hand · Warden of the Work	Disciplined troops, healing without price, and an expectation you will not like.
The Ysolde Remnant	Known · Trusted · Named	Safe houses across the Braid, forged permits, and Aveline answering the same day.
The Sixth Free Legion	Noted · Respected · Owed	Parley honoured, prisoners exchanged, and an officer who stays bought.
House Kell of Norvatch	Client · Factor's Guest · Signatory	Anything buyable, on time, plus three years of ledgers.
The Unbound Clerks	Enquirer · Reader · Keeper's Friend	The only people alive who can say what Vale has already read.

DM Only: the Tenth Work is where this campaign keeps its complexity, and it is on the party's own side of the line. They are allies, they will die holding a wall for the party, and they intend to do something to the liberated kingdom that a great many Elduvish would call a second occupation with better manners. Do not make them hypocrites and do not give them a secret plan.

THE PUZZLE INDEX

Every puzzle in the campaign, where it sits, and what solves it. Solutions are listed so a DM can recognise a good answer arriving from an unexpected direction, not so that only these answers count.

Module	Puzzle	What solves it
1	The Muster Roll	Count the billets, walk the range at dawn, or ask a Stannock pikeman how many of his village came.
1	The Ledge	Rope from above, bait it off, take the shepherds first, or bring the overhang down. No preferred answer.
2A	The Moved Light	Four pieces of evidence. Nobody moved a light; the harbour light was two hours late and Thane's boats were already crewed.
2B	The Back of the Charter	Notice that a framed document has a reverse. Best outcome is Vell reading it himself.
2B	The Signposted Corridor	Read Draconic, or work out that the marks are honest warnings by watching what the kobolds do.
3	Getting Past Wyn Alder	Be boring, be somebody else, split up to defeat the head count, or go round by the creeks.
4	What the Water Heard	Ten minutes at the ornamental canal. Three watches, not two; the bell rope is frayed.
5	Who Is Speaking	Four voices, none lying, none complete. Not meant to converge.
6	What the Kobolds Want	Grain from the undercroft, a written promise that will actually hold, and both before the route.
7	The Terms of the Binding	It must be commanded aloud. Silence the relay officer, the sound, or take the horn yourself.
8	Three Years of Filing	Filed by issuing office, not subject. The fourth office has no docket mark, which is itself the mark.
9	Voss's Field Orders	Company, hour, bearing. Doubled numerals are feints; no bearing at all means reserve.
10	Reading the Ledgers	Ordinary cargo is flat. All the increase is light-stone, and light-stone is the medium. About a third is gone.
11	Access by Rule	The rule has no exception and never had one. Vale was never close.

THE BRANCH LEDGER

Every tracked divergence across the campaign, compiled from each module's own Diverging Paths (DM Only) section. Fill in the last column at the table, as it happens — this is the record that makes the campaign replayable rather than a railroad with scenery, and it is the reason this document is single-column: these rows need the width.

Module	Divergence	Options	What Actually Happened
1	The wyvern's fate	Killed · driven off · roped and released	
1	Branch Ledger entry 1: the road choice	Sea road (2A) · Mountain road (2B)	
2A	How Thane's hold is settled	Paid off · talked down · fought	
2A	Calanthe's fate	Garrisoned · independent · hybrid	
2B	What the ford cost	A wagon · a delay · a near-miss · an actual loss	
2B	How Vell's toll was settled	Paid · talked down · bypassed · fought	
3	How the party treated Wyn Alder	Threatened · ignored · understood	
3	Whether the checkpoint turned violent	Yes (word reaches Caer Ysolde early) · No	
4	How Sennoch Hall was resolved	Stealth · violence · a mix	
4	The party's standing with Doria Kell	Face value · pressed for more · suspicion	
5	Branch Ledger entry 1, resolved	The party's own crossing, set against the second king's	
5	How the party engaged with the mourning at the Standing Water	Spoke at the water · listened only · kept apart	
6	How the engines were raised	Smoothly · roughly	
6	The supply raid's outcome	Clean success · failed or messy	
6	How First Assault was fought	Clear local win · costly draw · real loss	
7	How Marshal Drell's fate was resolved	Surrendered · killed · fled	
7	Scene 3: as written, or a direct dragon fight	As written · direct dragon fight	
8	How the Magistrate was freed	Caper · force	
8	Whether the party noticed the pressed clerk	Yes · No	
9	Which Scene 2 was run	Tam's death · the third-thread alternate	
9	General Voss's fate	Killed · captured · fled	
10	Whether Xavier signed Norvatch's contract	Signed · refused · deferred	
10	What the party told the Regent, and what the Regent told them	(Private DM note — not mechanically tracked)	
11	The campaign's final choice	Held · set down	
11	Vale's fate	Killed · escaped · captured	
1	What the party did about the muster roll	Reported it · buried it · never found it	
1	How the ledge was solved	Rope · baited off · shepherds first · overhang brought down	
2A	Whether the coalition was told the truth about Thane	Told · withheld · never established	
2A	Whether the draught team came off the ship	Saved · hatch closed	

Module	Divergence	Options	What Actually Happened
2B	How Vell came to honour the charter	He read it himself · shown it · taken from him · never found	
2B	How the Old Workings went	Read the marks · fought through · not entered	
3	How the party passed the Caerwyn checkpoint	Boring · forged · split up · went round · caught	
4	What the water at Sennoch Hall gave them	Used it · never tried it	
4	Hoth's surrender, and the file	Terms accepted · fought, file burned	
6	Whether the party opened the under-wall route	Negotiated · fought for it · never found it	
6	Whether the kobolds got their written promise	Signed and holds · signed and worthless · refused	
7	The bound dragon	Grounded · killed · neither	
7	Whether the binding instrument was recovered	Yes — names the office · No	
8	Whether the Keeper's Office drawer was found	Found · missed	
9	Whether Voss's reserve was located before it committed	Found · not found	
10	Whether the party worked out the number	Yes — about a third · No · refused the folio	
11	Whether the party established what the rule permits	Established · forced the doors · never reached them	
11	Whether the Sixth was bought out at term	Withdrew · declined to sortie · fought · never approached	

The final choice draws on everything above it — before running Module 11's Scene 4, a DM may find it worth reading back across this whole ledger with the table.